**AEGIS BANK**

**Code of Conduct**

***Enterprise AI Decision & Knowledge Platform for Modern Banking***

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**Document Information**

| Field | Details |
|---|---|
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| **Approved By** | **Sami Khan – Chief Executive Officer (CEO)** |

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**Confidentiality Notice**

This Code of Conduct is an internal governance document of **Aegis Bank**. It establishes the ethical principles, professional standards, and behavioral expectations that apply to all employees, contractors, consultants, interns, directors, and third-party personnel acting on behalf of the Bank.

Unauthorized distribution, reproduction, or modification of this document is prohibited unless approved by Human Resources and Executive Management.

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**1. Purpose**

The purpose of this Code of Conduct is to define the ethical principles, behavioral expectations, and professional responsibilities required of everyone working at Aegis Bank.

This document supports a culture of integrity, accountability, transparency, and regulatory compliance while protecting the Bank's reputation and maintaining the trust of customers, employees, shareholders, and regulators.

The objectives of this Code are to:

- Promote ethical decision-making.
- Maintain professional workplace behavior.
- Protect customer trust.
- Prevent fraud and misconduct.
- Encourage accountability.

- Support compliance with laws and regulations.
- Foster a respectful and inclusive workplace.

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**2. Scope**

This policy applies to:

- Full-Time Employees
- Part-Time Employees
- Temporary Staff
- Contractors
- Consultants
- Interns
- Executive Management
- Board Members
- Third-Party Personnel representing Aegis Bank

Compliance with this Code is a condition of employment and business engagement.

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**3. Core Values**

Every employee is expected to uphold the following values:

**Integrity**

Act honestly, ethically, and transparently in every decision.

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**Customer First**

Place customers at the center of every action while protecting their financial interests and personal information.

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**Accountability**

Take ownership of responsibilities, decisions, and outcomes.

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**Respect**

Treat colleagues, customers, partners, and stakeholders with dignity and professionalism.

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**Excellence**

Deliver high-quality work while continuously improving knowledge and skills.

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**Innovation**

Encourage responsible innovation and embrace technologies such as Artificial Intelligence to improve banking services.

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**Compliance**

Follow all applicable laws, regulations, and internal policies without exception.

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**4. Ethical Standards**

Employees must:

- Act honestly in all business activities.
- Avoid fraudulent behavior.
- Protect confidential information.
- Comply with banking regulations.
- Report suspected misconduct.
- Cooperate during investigations.
- Avoid misuse of authority.
- Protect the reputation of Aegis Bank.
- Make decisions in the best interests of the Bank and its customers.

Employees should exercise sound professional judgment when policies do not explicitly address a situation.

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**5. Professional Conduct**

Employees are expected to:

- Maintain professional behavior at all times.
- Communicate respectfully.
- Complete work accurately and responsibly.
- Meet deadlines.
- Follow approved procedures.
- Respect management decisions.
- Collaborate effectively with colleagues.
- Maintain professional appearance.
- Demonstrate punctuality and reliability.

Employees should avoid behavior that may damage the Bank's reputation or create conflicts within the workplace.

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**6. Respect in the Workplace**

Aegis Bank is committed to maintaining a workplace that is safe, inclusive, and free from discrimination, harassment, bullying, intimidation, retaliation, or violence.

Employees must:

- Respect different opinions.
- Promote teamwork.
- Support diversity.
- Maintain professionalism.
- Avoid abusive language.
- Report inappropriate behavior promptly.

## 7. Conflicts of Interest

### Purpose

Employees must always act in the best interests of Aegis Bank and avoid situations where personal interests may conflict, or appear to conflict, with the interests of the Bank.

A conflict of interest may influence—or appear to influence—an employee's objectivity, judgment, or professional responsibilities.

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### Examples of Conflicts of Interest

Potential conflicts include:

- Approving loans for immediate family members.
- Supervising close relatives without disclosure.
- Holding financial interests in competing financial institutions.
- Accepting employment with a competitor while employed by Aegis Bank.
- Using confidential information for personal financial gain.
- Participating in procurement decisions involving personal acquaintances.

Employees must disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest to Human Resources and the Compliance Department immediately.

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### Outside Employment

Employees may not engage in outside employment that:

- Creates a conflict of interest.
- Interferes with job responsibilities.
- Uses confidential Bank information.
- Competes directly with Aegis Bank.

Outside employment may require prior written approval from Human Resources.

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## 8. Gifts & Hospitality

Employees must never allow gifts, entertainment, or hospitality to influence business decisions.

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**Acceptable Gifts**

Examples include:

- Promotional company merchandise.
- Modest business meals.
- Low-value appreciation gifts permitted under Bank policy.

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**Prohibited Gifts**

Employees must not accept:

- Cash or cash equivalents.
- Luxury gifts.
- Expensive travel.
- Personal vacations funded by vendors.
- Gifts intended to influence business decisions.

Where required, gifts must be declared through the Bank's Gift & Hospitality Register.

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**9. Anti-Bribery & Anti-Corruption**

Aegis Bank maintains a zero-tolerance approach toward bribery and corruption.

Employees must never:

- Offer bribes.
- Accept bribes.
- Facilitate improper payments.
- Provide unauthorized financial incentives.
- Falsify business records.

Any suspected bribery must be reported immediately to the Compliance Department.

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**10. Confidentiality**

Employees are entrusted with highly sensitive information and must protect it throughout and after their employment.

Confidential information includes:

- Customer records
- Banking transactions
- Credit information
- Financial reports
- Internal audit findings
- AI models and prompts
- Cybersecurity architecture
- Source code
- Strategic business plans
- Personnel records

Confidential information must only be accessed and shared on a legitimate business need-to-know basis.

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**11. Social Media & Public Communications**

Employees must exercise professionalism when communicating publicly.

Employees must not:

- Represent personal opinions as official Bank statements.
- Share confidential information.
- Publish internal documents.
- Discuss customer matters publicly.
- Post misleading information about the Bank.

Only authorized spokespersons may communicate with the media on behalf of Aegis Bank.

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**12. Use of Bank Assets**

Bank assets include:

- Laptops
- Mobile devices
- Office equipment
- Software licenses
- Corporate email
- Cloud infrastructure
- Intellectual property
- AI platforms
- Financial resources

Employees are responsible for protecting these assets from loss, misuse, theft, or unauthorized access.

Bank assets must only be used for legitimate business purposes unless otherwise authorized.

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**13. Fraud Prevention**

Fraud threatens customer trust and organizational integrity.

Employees must immediately report suspected:

- Identity fraud
- Account fraud
- Expense fraud
- Procurement fraud
- Payroll fraud
- Document forgery
- Cyber fraud

- Internal collusion
- Money laundering activities

Retaliation against employees who report suspected fraud in good faith is strictly prohibited.

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**14. Reporting Misconduct (Whistleblower Protection)**

Employees are encouraged to report concerns regarding:

- Ethical violations
- Fraud
- Harassment
- Corruption
- Security breaches
- Regulatory violations
- Misuse of Bank assets
- Conflicts of interest

Reports may be submitted through:

- Reporting Manager
- Human Resources
- Compliance Department
- Information Security Team
- Internal Ethics Hotline

Reports made in good faith will be treated confidentially and investigated appropriately.

Employees making good-faith reports will be protected from retaliation.

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**15. Compliance with Laws & Internal Policies**

Employees are expected to comply with:

- Applicable employment laws

- Banking regulations
- Anti-Money Laundering (AML) requirements
- Know Your Customer (KYC) requirements
- Data privacy regulations
- Information Security policies
- AI Governance policies
- Internal operational procedures

Failure to comply may result in disciplinary action and, where applicable, legal consequences.

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**16. Disciplinary Actions**

Violations of this Code may result in:

- Coaching
- Verbal warning
- Written warning
- Final written warning
- Suspension
- Termination of employment

Serious misconduct—including fraud, corruption, theft, or intentional disclosure of confidential information—may result in immediate dismissal and referral to relevant authorities where required.

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**17. Practical Examples**

**Example 1 – Gift from a Vendor**

A vendor offers an expensive smartphone to an employee responsible for evaluating procurement bids.

**Correct Action**

The employee must politely decline the gift and report the offer through the Gift & Hospitality Register.

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**Example 2 – Conflict of Interest**

A Branch Manager is asked to approve a personal loan application submitted by a sibling.

**Correct Action**

The Branch Manager must disclose the conflict immediately and recuse themselves from the approval process.

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**Example 3 – Confidential Information**

An employee receives a request from a friend asking for details about another customer's account balance.

**Correct Action**

The employee must refuse the request and explain that customer information is confidential and protected by Bank policy.

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**Example 4 – Social Media**

An employee posts an internal strategy presentation on a personal social media account before its official release.

**Outcome**

This is a serious breach of confidentiality and may result in disciplinary action, including termination.

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**18. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)**

**Q1. Can I accept gifts from customers?**

Only low-value gifts permitted under Bank policy may be accepted. Gifts that could influence—or appear to influence—business decisions must be declined and reported.

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**Q2. What should I do if I discover unethical behavior?**

Report the matter immediately through your Manager, Human Resources, the Compliance Department, or the Ethics Hotline.

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**Q3. Can I discuss customer information with family members?**

No. Customer information is confidential and may only be shared with authorized personnel for legitimate business purposes.

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**Q4. Can I post photos from the office on social media?**

Only if the content does not disclose confidential information, violate security requirements, or breach internal policies. When in doubt, seek approval before posting.

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**Q5. Am I required to report a conflict of interest even if I am unsure?**

Yes. Employees should disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest so that it can be assessed appropriately.

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**19. Related Documents**

This policy should be read together with:

- Employee Handbook (AB-HR-001)
- Leave Policy (AB-HR-002)
- Recruitment Policy (AB-HR-003)
- Password Policy (AB-SEC-001)
- Information Security Policy (AB-SEC-003)
- AI Usage Policy (AB-AI-001)
- Anti-Money Laundering (AML) Policy (AB-OPS-003)

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**20. Revision History**

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|---|---|---|---|
| v1.0 | January 22, 2026 | Initial Release | Human Resources |
| v1.1 | April 25, 2026 | Updated Ethics & Reporting Requirements | Human Resources |
| **v1.2** | **July 24, 2026** | **Added AI Governance References, Enhanced Whistleblower Protection, and Expanded Conflict of Interest Guidelines** | **Human Resources** |

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**21. Document Approval**

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**End of Document**

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